

Hands-on Lab: Review Security Threat Reports using X-Force Threat Exchange

Estimated time needed: 15 minutes

X-Force Threat Exchange is a cloud-based, collaborative platform developed by IBM. Its primary function is facilitating user sharing of security-related information and threat intelligence. With X-Force, you have access to real-time feeds of threat intelligence shared by other users. You can also contribute data about potential threats, vulnerabilities, and risky IP addresses. The ability to exchange information allows everyone to enhance their cybersecurity measures, stay up-to-date about the latest threats, and take proactive steps to protect the systems and networks.

Objectives

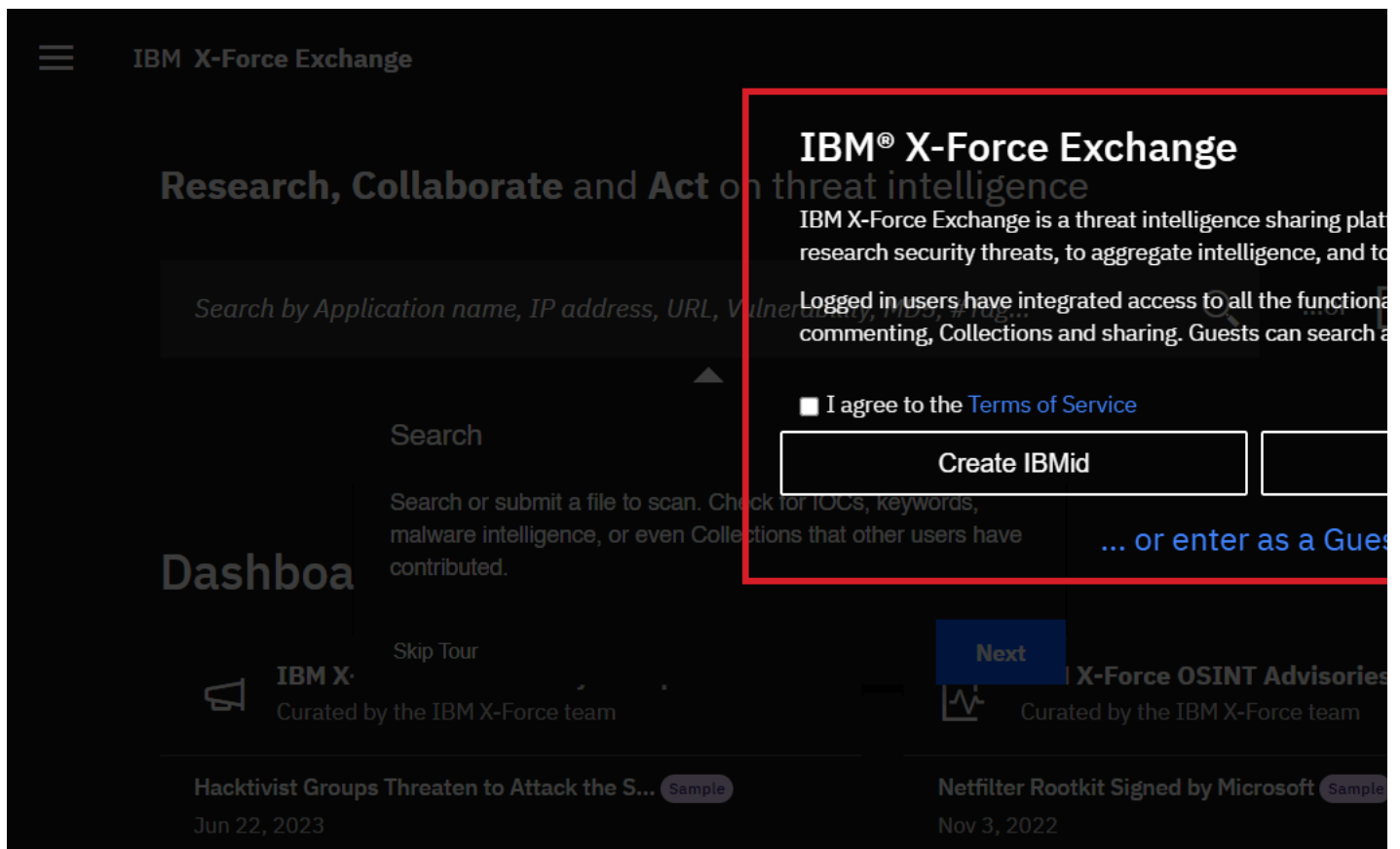
After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Navigate the X-force Exchange Dashboard
- Review available reports and information

Exercise 1: Get started with X-Force Exchange Dashboard

In this exercise, you will launch the X-Force Exchange website and take a tour of the Dashboard.

1. Launch the IBM X-Force Exchange website by using the URL, <https://exchange.xforce.ibmcloud.com/>.
2. The first time that you log in to the site, you will be prompted to either create an IBM ID, login with valid credentials, or enter as a guest.



3. For this demo:
 1. Select the **Terms of Service** checkbox.
 2. Click **enter as Guest**.
4. The X-Force Exchange Dashboard is displayed. The first time when you enter the X-Force Exchange Dashboard, a tour of the Dashboard will automatically launch. You can either click **Next** to continue with the tour or click **Skip tour** to display the X-Force Exchange Dashboard.

The screenshot shows the IBM X-Force Exchange dashboard. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the IBM X-Force Exchange logo and a search bar. Below the navigation bar, the main heading reads "Research, Collaborate and Act on threat intelligence". A search bar is prominently displayed with the placeholder text "Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...". A red rectangular box highlights a search tour overlay. The overlay contains the text "Search" followed by "Search or submit a file to scan. Check for IOCs, keywords, malware intelligence, or even Collections that other users have contributed." At the bottom of the overlay are two buttons: "Skip Tour" and "Next". The dashboard itself is divided into several sections. On the left, there is a "Dashboard" section with a list of threat intelligence items, including "Hactivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S...", "Update: Hactivists Continue Targeting...", "PWNLNK Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T...", and "Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On...". On the right, there is a section for "X-Force OSINT Advisories" with items like "Netfilter Rootkit Signed by Microsoft" and "New Undetected Python-Based Info-Stealer". At the bottom, there are two more sections: "IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports" and "IBM X-Force Industry Reports".

IBM X-Force Exchange

Research, Collaborate and Act on threat intelligence

Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...

Search

Search or submit a file to scan. Check for IOCs, keywords, malware intelligence, or even Collections that other users have contributed.

Skip Tour

Next

Dashboard

IBM X-Force OSINT Advisories

Hactivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S... Sample

Jun 22, 2023

Update: Hactivists Continue Targeting... Oct 26, 2023

PWNLNK Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T... Oct 18, 2023

Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On... Oct 12, 2023

View more

Netfilter Rootkit Signed by Microsoft Sample

Nov 3, 2022

New Undetected Python-Based Info-Stealer Oct 27, 2023 Updated

FakeUpdateRU Chrome Update Infection Spr Oct 27, 2023 Updated

Donation Fraud: Scammers Exploit Generosit Oct 27, 2023 Updated

IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

IBM X-Force Industry Reports

Curated by the IBM X-Force team

5. Familiarize yourself with the layout and functionalities by taking the tour.

6. The Dashboard provides a high-level overview of all the shared threat intelligence.

IBM X-Force Exchange

Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...

Dashboard

IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Hacktivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S... [Sample](#)
Jun 22, 2023

Update: Hacktivists Continue Targeting... [Sample](#)
Oct 26, 2023

PWNLNK Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T... [Sample](#)
Oct 18, 2023

Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On... [Sample](#)
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[View more](#)

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Oct 27, 2023

IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

HermeticWiper Analysis Report (IRIS-12790) [Sample](#)
Feb 25, 2023

IBM X-Force Industry Reports
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Transportation Industry Profile [Sample](#)
Jul 10, 2023

1. What are your observations from the Dashboard?

► Click here for some key observations about the Dashboard.

Note: You can unlock reports on the Dashboard if you have an account. You can create the account via the **Create IBMId** link at the top-right corner of the Dashboard.

Exercise 2: Review X-Force reports and other information

In this exercise, you will explore reports and information available in the different sections.

Task 1: Review X-Force Threat Analysis Reports

1. **IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports** is the first report section on the Dashboard and provides a list of the most recent threats compiled by the IBM X-Force team.

IBM X-Force Exchange

Research, Collaborate and Act on threat intelligence

Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag...  ...or 

Dashboard

**IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports**
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

Hacktivist Groups Threaten to Attack the S... [Sample](#)
Jun 22, 2023

Update: Hacktivists Continue Targeting...
Oct 26, 2023 

PWNLNK Utilizes Linux Kernel Rootkit T...
Oct 18, 2023 

Credential Phishing Leveraging AitM On...
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**IBM X-Force OSINT Advisories**
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**IBM X-Force Malware Analysis Reports**
Curated by the IBM X-Force team

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Feb 25, 2023

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Transportation Industry Profile [Sample](#)
Jul 10, 2023

The **IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports** section provides comprehensive documents that detail specific cybersecurity threats. Each piece typically includes a brief overview of the threat, its origin or source, and the nature of its potential impact on your system. It also highlights the vulnerabilities that the threat may exploit. This aids you in understanding any specific weakness in your system that can potentially be compromised.

The reports also provide information about the IP addresses of the threat targets. This helps users identify if their networks or certain parts of their networks have been, or could be, targeted. These analysis reports often include mitigation strategies or recommendations for protecting your systems against the identified threat. This equips users with practical, actionable steps to enhance their cybersecurity measures.

2. Hover over a report name for a brief overview of the report.
3. Click a report to view the details. For this exercise, click any available unlocked report.
4. A detailed view of the report will be displayed. You will find details, such as the threat's source, reported vulnerabilities, and the affected IP addresses.
5. Optionally, you can explore other reports in the **IBM X-Force Threat Analysis Reports** section.

Task 2: Review the Early Warning Data section

1. Scroll down to the Early Warning Data section.

IBM X-Force Exchange

Early Warning Data
Stay ahead of threats with Early Warning data

- zosjkfg.store**
Registered: 2 hours ago
- zamgnytw.shop**
Registered: 2 hours ago
- yoyiuiwhjhe.shop**
Registered: 2 hours ago
- ylrdhcqsgu.shop**
Registered: 2 hours ago

Coronavirus Attack Source Dist
Attack map related to COVID-19

Affected Countries/Regions **71**
Peak **Apr**
Trend **↑**

Vulnerabilities
The latest global security risks

Public Collections
Publicly shared community findings

Recommended

Apache ActiveMQ and ActiveMQ Legacy OpenWire Module code execution
Consequences: Gain Access

This section provides users with critical, forward-looking information about emerging threats and potential vulnerabilities. The data in this section is new and includes information added within the few hours and is designed to provide you with a head start in identifying, understanding, and mitigating unknown risks before they become widespread issues. Examples of early warning data include newly discovered malware, suspicious IP activity, unusual network patterns, and other potential signs of compromise.

2. Hover the mouse over an early warning for additional information.
3. Click an early warning for more details.

Task 3: Review the Malicious Activity section

1. The **Malicious Activity** section provides a real-time map-based feed of security events flagged as potentially malicious within the last hour. It offers critical insights into the latest threat landscape, including details about the types of attacks, their sources, targeted regions, and the affected IP addresses. Each event in this section is linked to a more detailed report, offering users a deeper understanding of the threat, its potential impact, and recommended mitigation strategies.

IBM X-Force Exchange

Early Warning Data

Stay ahead of threats with Early Warning data

zosjkfg.store

Registered: 2 hours ago

zamgnytw.shop

Registered: 2 hours ago

yoyuiwhjhe.shop

Registered: 2 hours ago

ylrdhcqsgu.shop

Registered: 2 hours ago

Coronavirus Attack Source Distribution

Attack map related to COVID-19

Affected Countries/Regions71

PeakApr

Trend

Vulnerabilities

The latest global security risks

Apache ActiveMQ and ActiveMQ Legacy OpenWire Module code execution

Consequences: Gain Access

Public Collections

Publicly shared community findings

Recommended

2. Click the **Spam** data.
3. You will be able to view a complete report all IP addresses recently categorized for spam.

☰

IBM X-Force Exchange

ALL ▾

Search by Application name, IP address, URL, Vulnerability, MD5, #Tag.

Recently categorized IP addresses for Spam

IP	123.188.39.156	Spam, Dynamic IPs	China
IP	137.74.68.33	Spam	France
IP	42.57.190.120	Spam, Dynamic IPs	China
IP	143.198.38.254	Spam	United States
IP	186.141.202.227	Spam, Bots	Argentina
IP	191.101.31.66	Spam	United States
IP	41.251.227.138	Spam, Dynamic IPs, Bots	Morocco
IP	105.158.108.107	Spam, Bots	Morocco
IP	196.65.72.9	Spam, Dynamic IPs, Bots	Morocco
IP	5.31.207.107	Spam, Dynamic IPs, Bots	United Arab Emirates
IP	113.226.103.68	Spam, Dynamic IPs	China
IP	117.50.60.213	Spam	

This brings us to the end of the lab.

Congratulations! You have successfully completed this lab on X-Force Threat Exchange.

Author(s)

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Skills Network